

This book belongs to

Oliver

A Christmas gift from

Christmas



The Box on the Doorstep



On the first morning of December, Biscuit barked at the front door. On the mat sat a box tied with red ribbon and a tag shaped like a star.

Inside was a tiny letter: “Dear *Oliver*,
Santa’s sleigh runs on Christmas Spirit,
and this year it is running low. Please help!
Finish twelve missions before Christmas
Eve and every one will add a star to your
list. Love, Pip the Elf.”

★ Pip hides in every picture. Can you find
him?

And under the letter, something green and
round was waiting...

Oliver's Mission List

Draw a star when each mission is done

- 1 Deck the house ☐
- 2 Write a letter to Santa ☐
- 3 Decorate the Christmas tree ☐
- 4 Make a handmade ornament ☐
- 5 Go see the Christmas lights ☐
- 6 Build a snowman ☐
- 7 Hot cocoa and a Christmas movie ☐
- 8 Build a gingerbread house ☐
- 9 Do something kind ☐
- 10 Sing Christmas carols ☐
- 11 Wrap the presents ☐
- 12 Cookies and milk for Santa ☐

Deck the House



Inside the box was a wreath with a big red bow, and it belonged on the front door.

Oliver hung it a little crooked, which made it just right. A paper snowflake for the window, a snow globe for the shelf.

Biscuit tried to wear the bow.

★ **One more star on the list.**

And on the hall table, paper and crayons were waiting...



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Dear Santa



Oliver drew a big tree, a red sled and Biscuit in a Santa hat. Then came the hardest part: deciding what to wish for. In the end the list said *a sled, a book about dinosaurs, and a happy Christmas for everybody*. Biscuit signed it with a paw print.

★ **One more star on the list.**

That night, the smell of pine came drifting through the door...



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The Perfect Tree

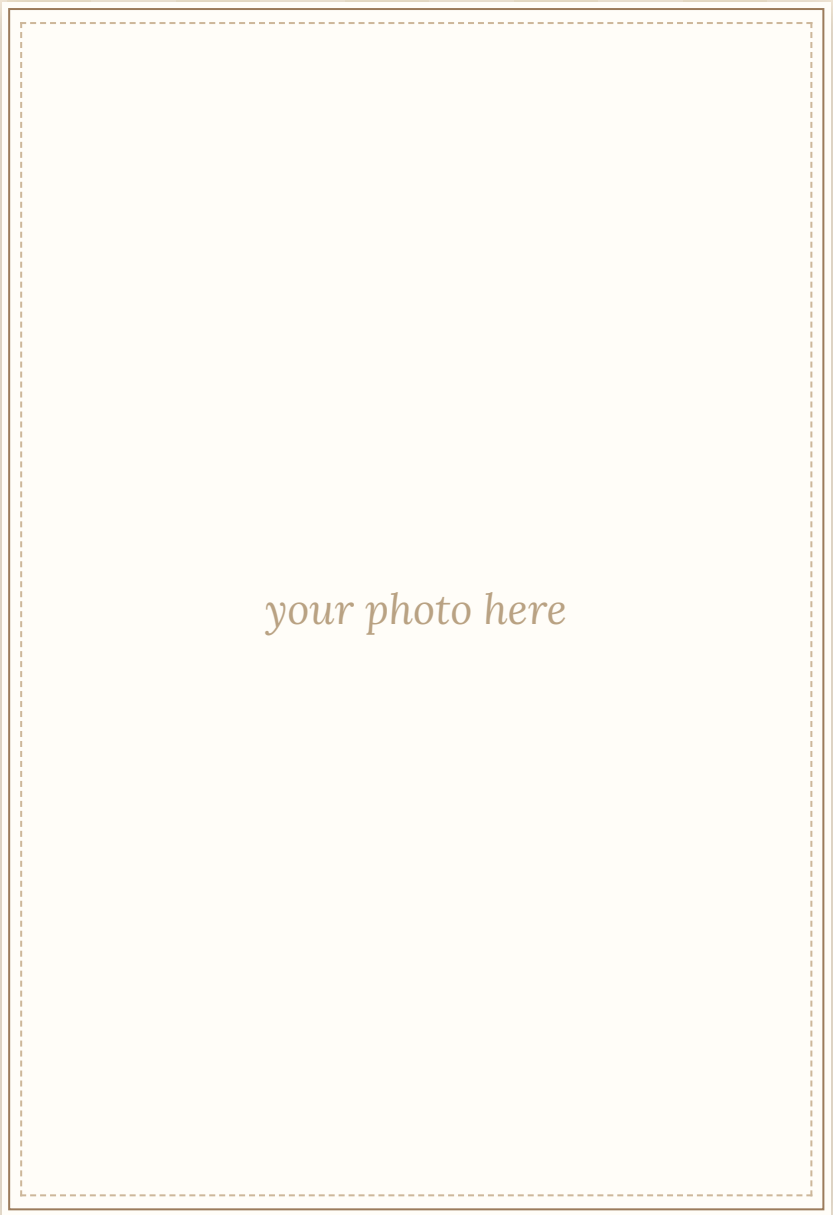


There it stood, tall and green, in the corner of the living room. First the lights, round and round. Then the ornaments, one by one, each with its own story.

Oliver was lifted up high to put the star on top. Biscuit guarded the tinsel, mostly by sitting in it.

★ **One more star on the list.**

But one branch, right in the front, was still empty...



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Made by Me



Some ornaments come from a store. The best ones are made at the kitchen table.

With paper, glue, glitter and a lot of concentration, **Oliver** made a star for the empty branch and wrote the year on the back. There was glitter everywhere. There was glitter on Biscuit for a week.

★ **One more star on the list.**

*When it got dark, the houses down the street
began to twinkle...*



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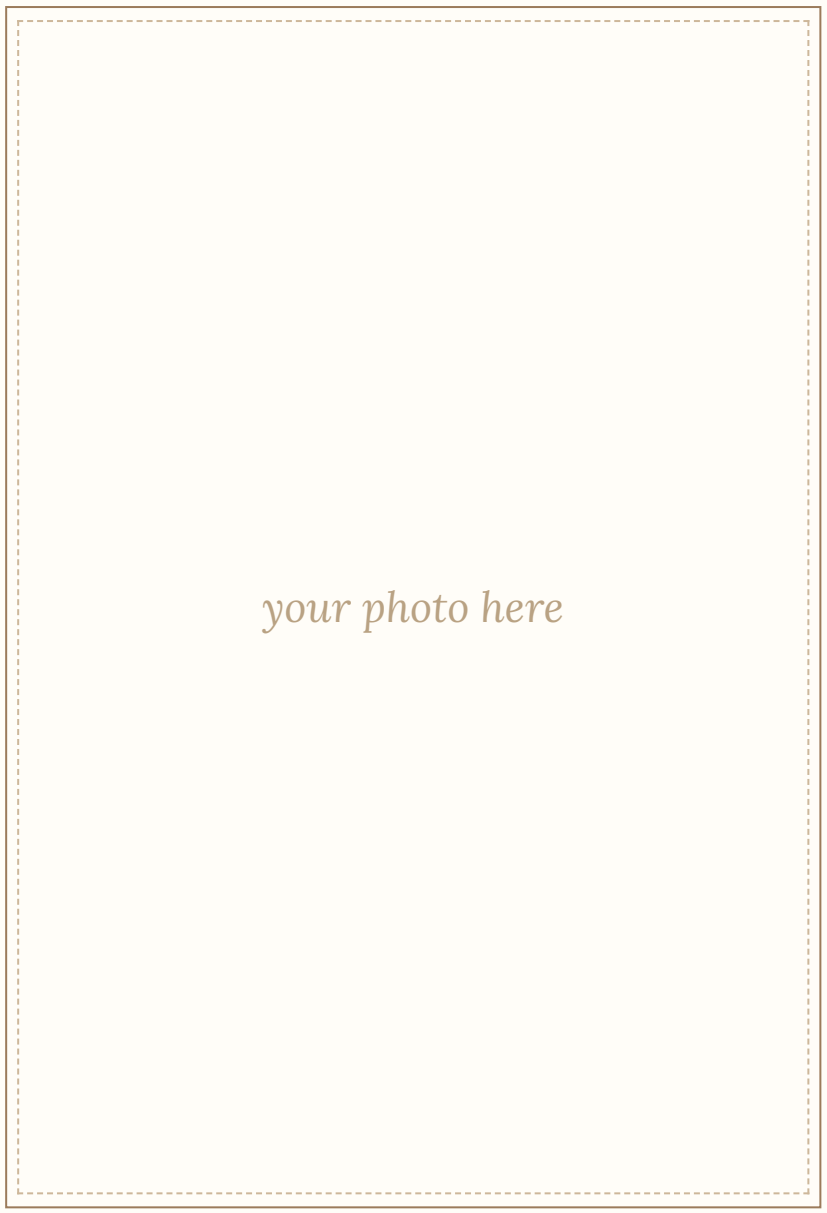
Lights on Our Street



Bundled up in coats and scarves,
everyone went out to see the lights. One
house had a giant snowman. One had
reindeer on the roof. One blinked in time
to music! **Oliver** gave every house a score
out of ten, and Biscuit barked at an
inflatable penguin.

★ **One more star on the list.**

*And while everyone slept, the sky began to
drop something soft and white...*



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Snow Day!



The whole yard was white! **Oliver** rolled a little snowball into a big one, and a big one into a bigger one. A carrot nose, two buttons, a red scarf. Biscuit chased every snowball and caught none of them. (No snow where you live? Paper snowflakes count too!)

★ **One more star on the list.**

Cold noses and pink cheeks could only mean one thing...



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Cocoa and a Movie

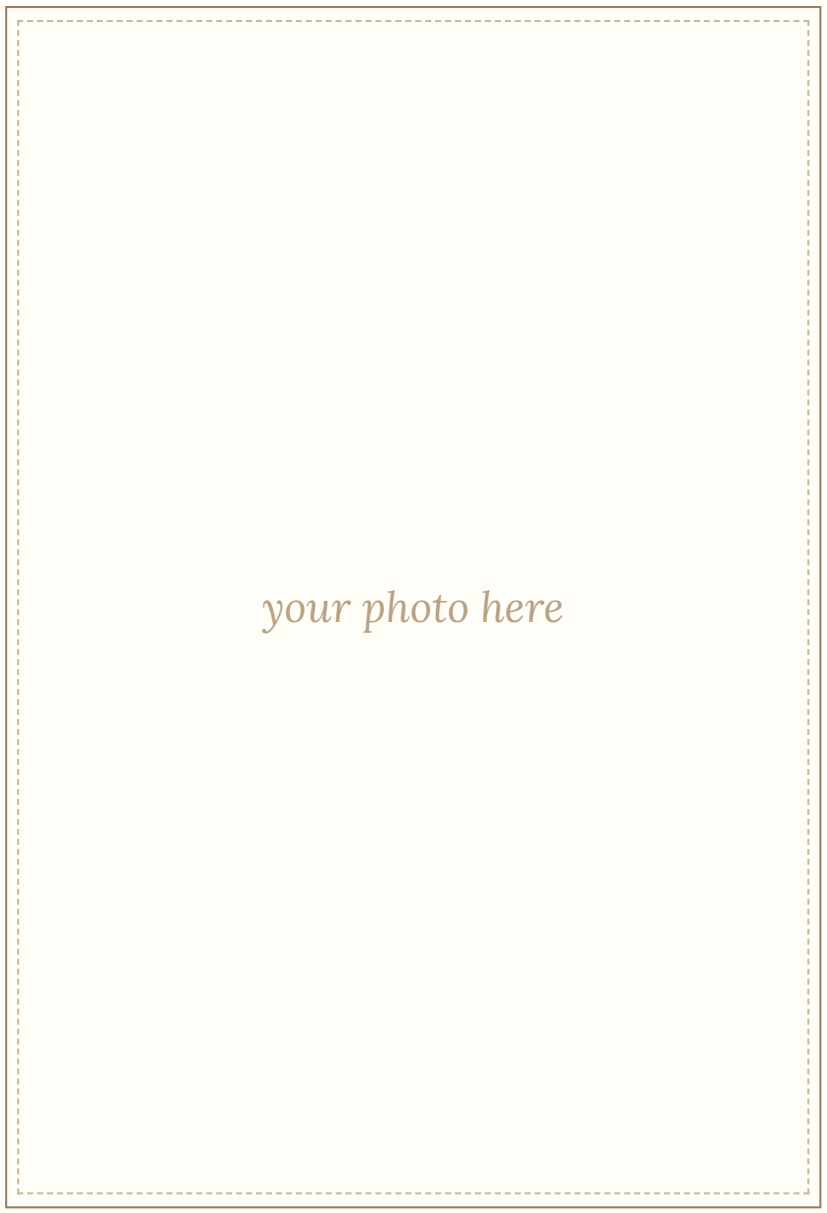


Pajamas on. Blankets on the couch. Hot cocoa in the big mugs, with marshmallows floating like little clouds.

Everyone squeezed together for a Christmas movie, and Biscuit got the best spot, right in the middle.

★ One more star on the list.

*In the movie there was a little house made of gingerbread, and **Oliver** had an idea...*



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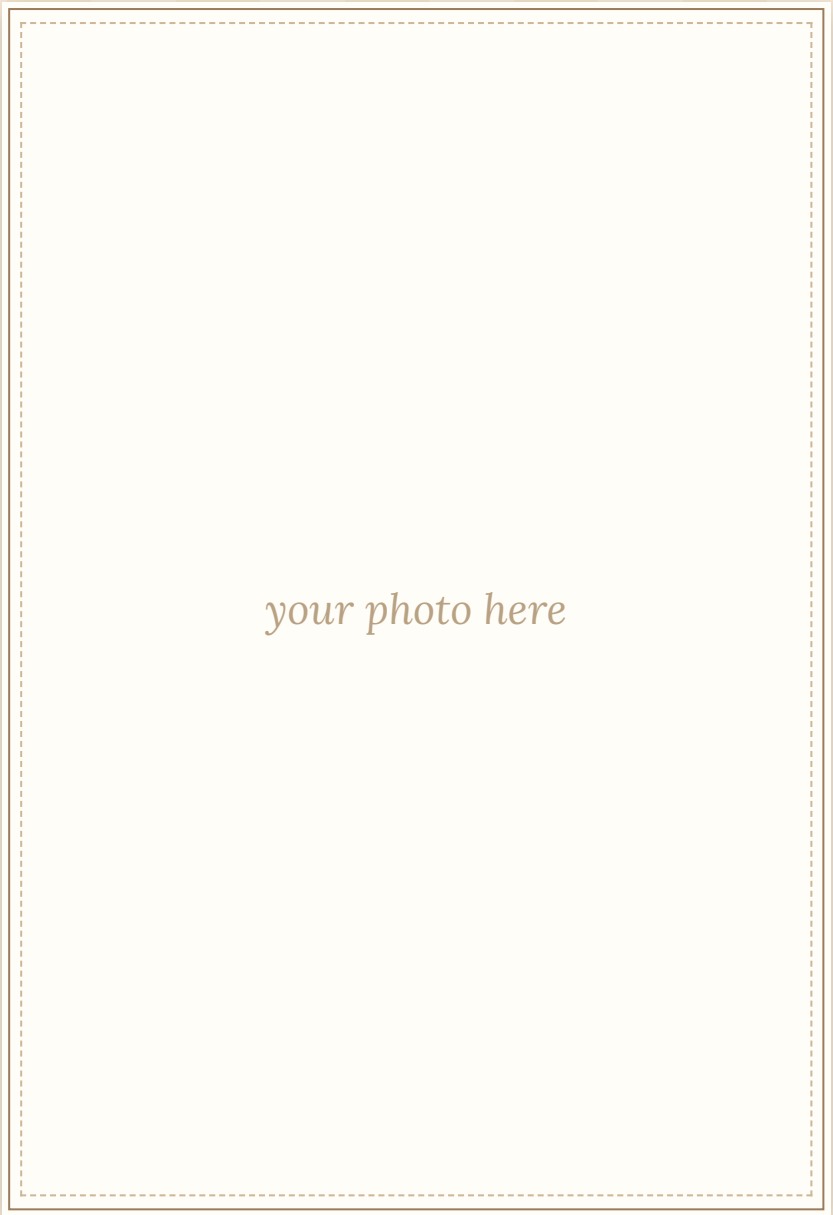
The Gingerbread House



Walls of gingerbread, a roof of icing snow,
candy-cane posts and gumdrop windows.
The walls fell down twice. The third time,
they stayed! **Oliver** ate one gumdrop for
every gumdrop on the roof, which
seemed fair.

★ **One more star on the list.**

*Stuck in the frosting was a note from Pip:
“The sweetest gift is kindness...”*



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A Kind Heart



Oliver chose a toy to give to a child who needed one, and carried a plate of cookies next door. Mrs. Rose smiled so big that her glasses slid down her nose. Kindness, it turns out, makes you feel warm all over, even in December.

★ **One more star on the list.**

On the way home, a song came floating down the street...



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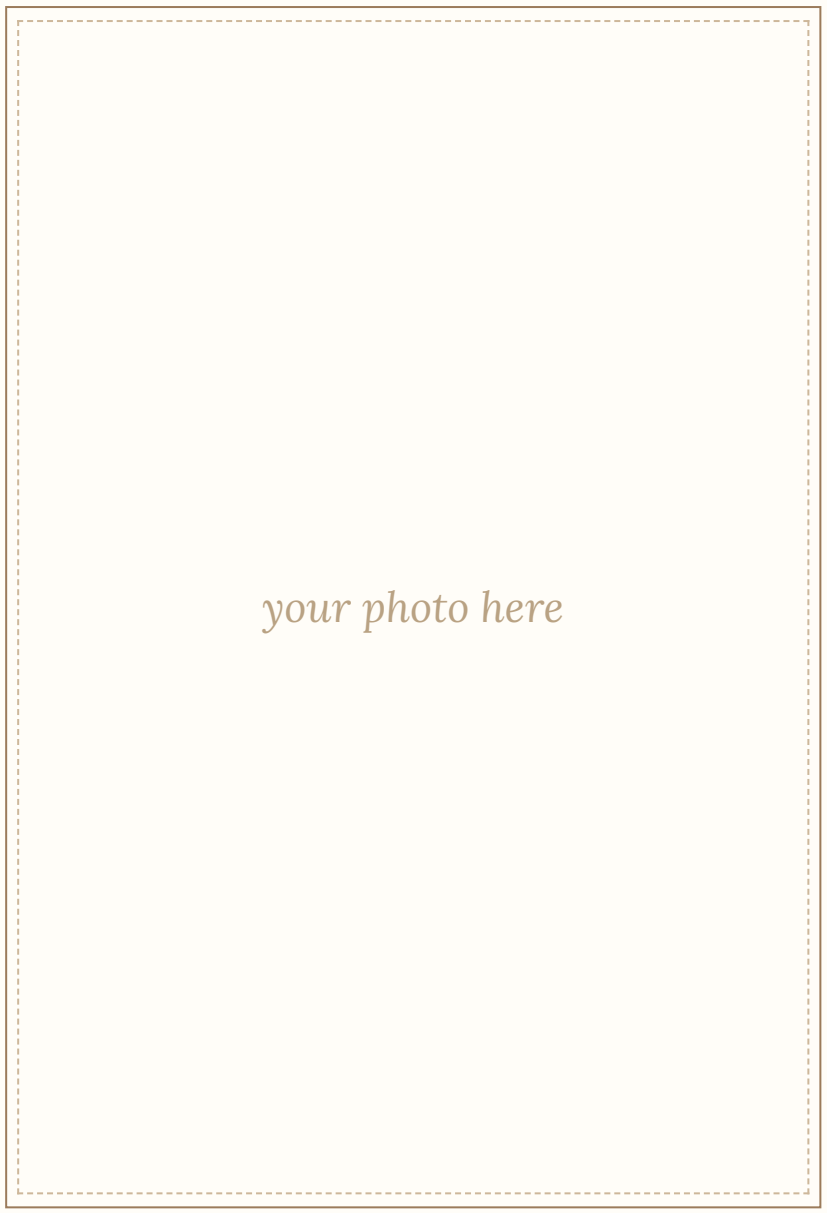
Sing Along



Jingle Bells, Silent Night and Rudolph the Red-Nosed Reindeer. Oliver sang loud. Oliver sang soft. Oliver sang for Grandma on the phone. Biscuit howled along on every chorus, a little off-key, but full of Christmas Spirit.

★ One more star on the list.

Meanwhile, under the bed, a pile of presents was waiting to be wrapped...



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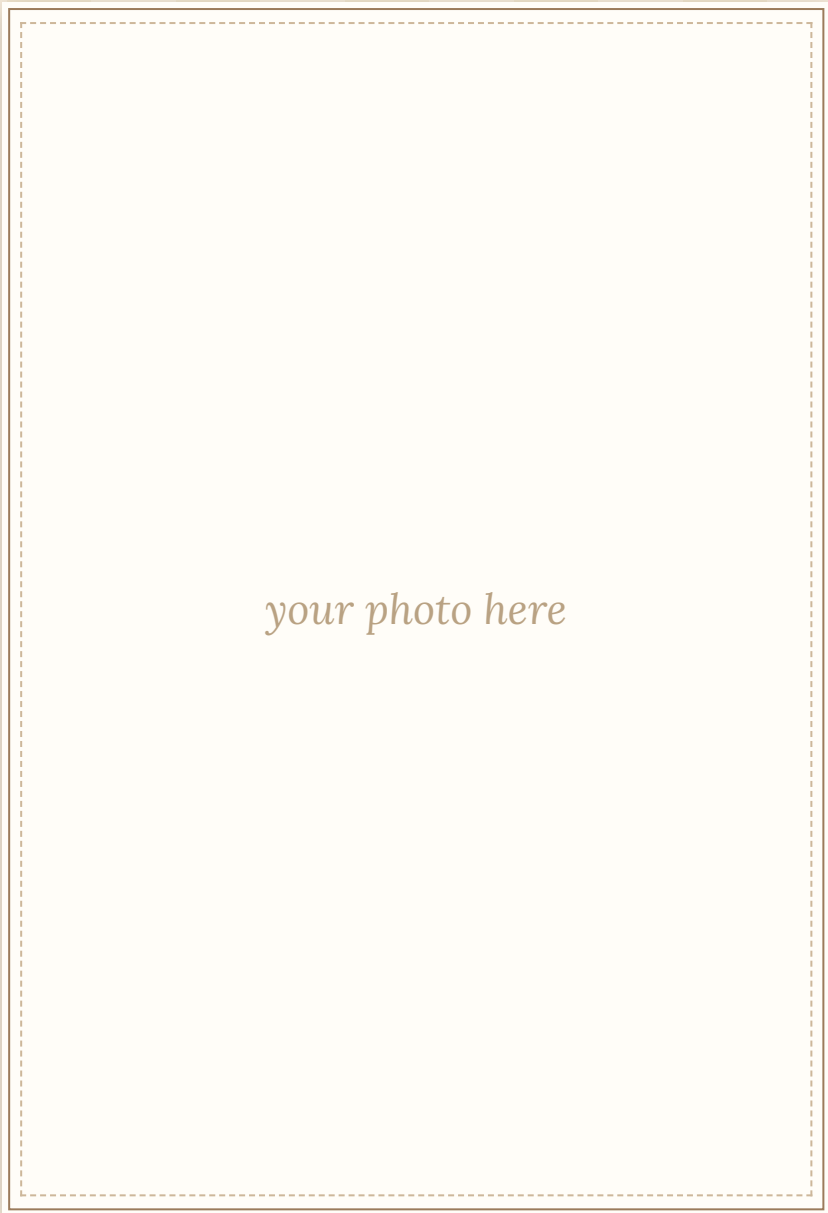
It's a Wrap



Paper with snowmen, paper with stars
and far too much tape. **Oliver** folded the
corners, tied the ribbons and wrote every
tag very carefully. One present looked a
lot like a bone. Biscuit was very interested
in that one.

★ **One more star on the list.**

*Christmas Eve was almost here, and Santa
would surely be hungry...*



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Cookies for Santa



Oliver baked star cookies, poured a glass of milk and sprinkled reindeer food on the snow outside. Stockings were hung and pajamas were on. The house was quiet. Biscuit kept one ear open, just in case.

★ One more star on the list.

Then, very late, there was a faint jingle on the roof...



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Christmas Morning



In the morning there were sleigh tracks in the snow, crumbs on the plate and a note on the tree:

*“Thank you, **Oliver**! Santa’s sleigh flew brighter than ever. You are an Official Christmas Spirit Helper. See you next year! Love, Pip.”*

★ Twelve stars on the list. Mission complete!



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My Christmas Memories

My favorite mission was...

The funniest moment was...

This Christmas I am thankful for...

Next Christmas I want to...

